

The First World War

Causes of the War

The war began in the summer of 1914 after a series of alliances failed.

Nationalism and imperial rivalry had built tension for decades.

The assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand was the spark.

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The Western Front

Trench warfare stretched from the North Sea to the Swiss border.
Machine guns and artillery made frontal attacks extremely costly.
Soldiers endured mud, cold, and the constant threat of gas.

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The Armistice

The fighting stopped on 11 November 1918.

The armistice came after the German leadership collapsed.

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The Treaty of Versailles was signed in 1919.

It imposed heavy reparations on Germany and redrew the map of Europe.

Many historians see the settlement as a cause of the next war.